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Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

Region: Africa

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As generalizations of their expectation of experience with other human beings, this idealistic model of man really only applies to other G/wi. Non-G/wi strangers are certainly not ignored, but the cautious reserve with which they are initially treated is hardly in the spirit of the instructions given to initiands. The G/wi stereotypes of ethnic groups are also at variance with the idealistic model of man. The most familiar ethnic group among Bushmen are the G//ana, whom the G/wi seem to like well enough but regard as being inclined to *sehasi* (greed). The Nharo (who are more correctly called by their self-appellation, G#eikhwena, People of the Calcrete Outcrop, but Nharo, the #ãũ//ei name for them, is current in the literature) are said to be angry and likely to help themselves to the possessions of the G/wi. The pejorative nature of the stereotype increases with distance and rarity of interaction. The #ãũ//ei are greatly feared for their supposed fierceness and ability to transform themselves into lions and prey upon people. The G//ulu are believed to be cannibals with voracious appetites. Non-Bushmen are categorized as #ibina (Bantu in general but usually Kgalagari, with whom the desert G/wi have occasional contact) or /o:xana (Europeans). Further divisions into tribes or nationalities do not exist and I saw no evidence that the G/wi have any cognizance of these. Although the names are not pejorative, they lack the favorable connotations of *khwena*, which is used only in reference to individual Bantu and Europeans when they have become known and trusted. The stereotypical non-Bushman is short-tempered, aggressive, and given to irrational actions. Nevertheless, Bantu and Europeans are considered to be superior because of their apparently greater knowledge and physical strength. (The G/wi consider themselves inferior to all other peoples in the extent of the progress they have made in discovering the means and techniques of overcoming the problems besetting man as one of N!adima's creatures.) Although afraid of non-Bushmen, they do not consider them to be evil but as having dangerous or potentially dangerous ways of behaving, which one must first learn to avoid or deal with before establishing friendly relations.

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The category of human beings is concentrically subdivided, the radial distance of the subcategories from Ego being inversely proportional 62

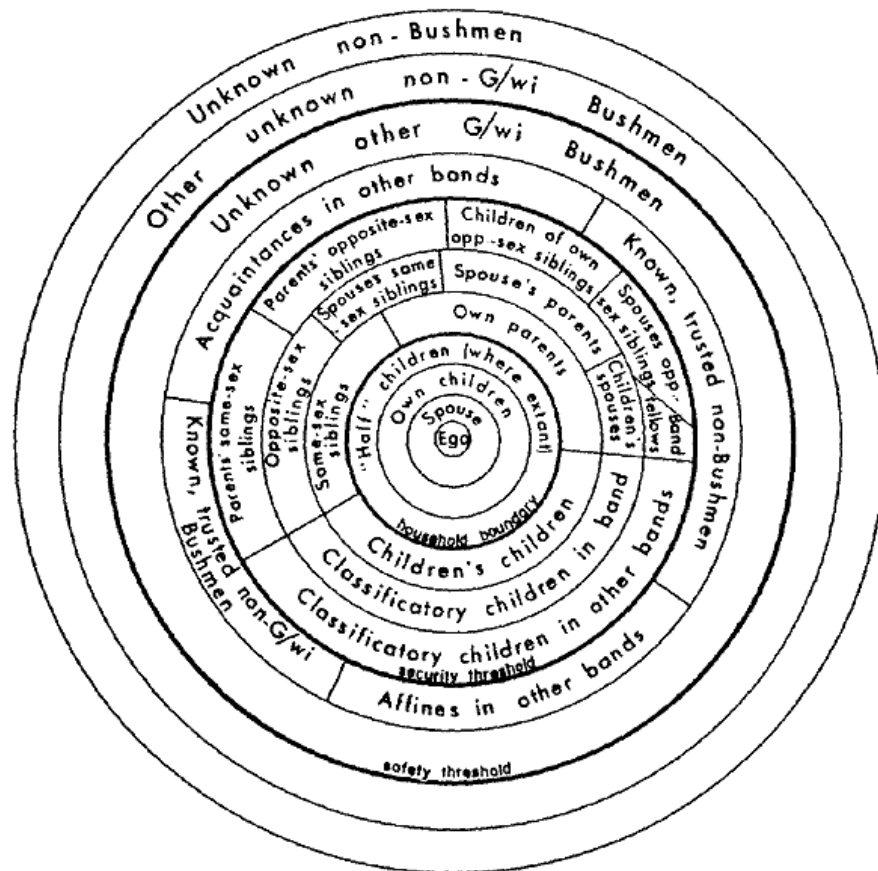
Figure 7. Categorization of human beings in the G/wi culture.

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to the frequency of interaction and the intensity of emotional attachment between Ego and those in the subcategory. In the subcategories represented by the three outer rings of Figure 7, radial distance is a function of perceived ethnic distance and is a projection of the categorization of attitudes toward known individuals in those ethnic categories. The contents of the inner-ring subcategories is determined by the kinship taxonomy; the innermost two or three rings represent the household, the personnel of which vary with age and the status of age. In the case of unmarried individuals, the inner ring consists of same-sex siblings (with whom interaction is most frequent and emotionally intense), with parents and opposite-sex siblings being placed in the second ring. The figure represents the situation of a mature individual, that is, a married man or woman with 63 married children. Although the rate of interaction is approximately uniform around each ring, the extrahousehold rings are divided into segments, as the quality differs, for example, according to whether there is a joking or avoidance relationship between Ego and the persons concerned.

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